

Jesus Freed Israel From the Law

The Law of the New Nature Frees Us From the Old Nature

The only thing that could free you from sin was a change of nature. The law of the new nature freed you from the law of the old nature, the law that governs sin and death.

Where did the law of the Spirit of life come into existence? It came into existence in Christ Jesus. He was born spiritually alive, died spiritually, and was brought back to life. The law that brought Him from death to life is the same law that brought your spirit from death to life when you were quickened together with Him and seated in heavenly places.

That law came into existence in His spirit, and it has now come into existence in your spirit. It set you free from the law of sin and death and from sin's friends.

The third Person of the Godhead stepped inside my spirit to empower the abundance of grace and my reign through righteousness. When the Holy Ghost is at full power in you, He glorifies Jesus. He speaks what He hears and magnifies Christ inside the new nature.

The Holy Spirit Enforces the Reign of Righteousness

Sin used to reign through spiritual death. Now the opposite is true. You have God inside you.

The law of the Spirit of life in your new nature freed you from sin. Sin and its friends no longer have power to reign over you. The Holy Ghost has come to help your reign through the abundance of grace and righteousness all the way to eternal life.

Romans 6 explains why this is possible.

Baptized Into His Death, We Share His Resurrection Life

Romans 6:1-5 says:

"What shall we say then?

Shall we continue in sin, that grace may abound?

God forbid.

How shall we, that are dead to sin, live any longer therein?

Know ye not, that so many of us as were baptized into Jesus Christ were baptized into his death?

Therefore we are buried with him by baptism into death:

that like as Christ was raised up from the dead by the glory of the Father,
even so we also should walk in newness of life."

Both Jew and Gentile had to be baptized into Jesus' death so they could be baptized into His life.

The death here is not merely His physical death. We were planted together in the likeness of His spiritual death. We were already spiritually dead, but when we accepted what He did as our Substitute, we were baptized into His death so we could also share His resurrection.

If we have been planted together in the likeness of His death, we are also of His resurrection. We come out of spiritual death with the same newness of life He came out with.

The Old Man and the Body of Sin Were Destroyed

Romans 6:6 says:

"Knowing this, that our old man is crucified with him,
that the body of sin might be destroyed,
that henceforth we should not serve sin."

The old man was crucified with Him. The body of sin was destroyed.

That body of sin is not your physical body. It refers to the inner man that housed the old death nature. Whatever encased the old sin nature was destroyed. There is nowhere for sin to go inside you and find that old man for help.

The old man does not exist anymore. The one who committed those sins died when they were laid on Jesus. The new creation has no past. The new man is not the same person as the old man who was destroyed.

I have been born again. I am a new creation and a free man. I have no past and no old limitation.

Dead to Sin Means Sin Lost Dominion

Romans 6:7-14 says:

"For he that is dead is freed from sin.
Now if we be dead with Christ,
we believe that we shall also live with him...
Likewise reckon ye also yourselves to be dead indeed unto sin,
but alive unto God through Jesus Christ our Lord.
Let not sin therefore reign in your mortal body,
that ye should obey it in the lusts thereof...
For sin shall not have dominion over you."

Christ died unto sin once, and now He lives unto God. Likewise, reckon yourself dead indeed unto sin and alive unto God.

Sin does not have dominion over you.

God Needed a Client Nation to Carry the Oracles

After showing that both Jew and Gentile had to be baptized into Jesus' death because all had the same nature, Paul returns to the Jewish community.

What profit was there in circumcision? God had to have a client nation to work through. He needed someone to receive the oracles and serve the altars. If He had waited for you, the nation could have been named after you. But He approached Abraham, and Abraham said yes.

God entered covenant with a man, making everything heaven had available to him, while everything Abraham had become available to heaven. Through that covenant, God began to work.

Judaism later believed the law saved them. It accepted that Gentiles could become Abraham's seed, but taught that after Gentiles received the promise, they had to keep the law to be perfected. That is what Paul is contending against.

Romans 7 Speaks to Those Who Know the Law

Romans 7:1 says:

"Know ye not, brethren,
(for I speak to them that know the law,)
how that the law hath dominion over a man as long as he liveth?"

Paul is speaking to those who know the law, especially the Jewish community.

For a long time, I would skip down to verse 7, where Paul says, "Is the law sin? God forbid." I did not think there was much in the first six verses. But then I saw that Paul was revealing the new nature there.

He shows how Jesus set the Jew free from the law. Israel was married to God through the law, but when Jesus died and the law died with Him, He represented every human being under it and freed Israel to be married to another.

Death Frees the Wife to Marry Another

Romans 7:2-3 says:

"For the woman which hath an husband
is bound by the law to her husband so long as he liveth;
but if the husband be dead,
she is loosed from the law of her husband.
So then if, while her husband liveth,
she be married to another man,
she shall be called an adulteress:
but if her husband be dead,
she is free from that law;
so that she is no adulteress,
though she be married to another man."

Paul uses this example to bring a conclusion:

"Wherefore, my brethren,
ye also are become dead to the law by the body of Christ;
that ye should be married to another,
even to him who is raised from the dead,
that we should bring forth fruit unto God."

Israel was married to God by the law. They were spiritually dead and could not keep it, but they were bound to it. Through the body of Christ, that old man was crucified and the body of sin destroyed. The man held under the law died in Christ.

That freed them to be married to another, even to Him who is raised from the dead.

Newness of Spirit Replaces Oldness of Letter

Romans 7:5-6 says:

"For when we were in the flesh,
the motions of sins, which were by the law,
did work in our members to bring forth fruit unto death.
But now we are delivered from the law,
that being dead wherein we were held;
that we should serve in newness of spirit,
and not in the oldness of the letter."

"In the flesh" here describes the spiritually dead man married to God through the law. The motions of sin were by the law because the law said, "Thou shalt not covet," "Thou shalt not bear false witness," and "Thou shalt have no other gods," yet the man had a nature that could not keep those commands.

When the old man was crucified with Jesus, the old nature that had been held under the law died. Now we serve in newness of spirit, out of the new nature, and not in oldness of letter.

The Law Revealed Sin Because the Dead Man Could Not Know Himself

Romans 7:7 says:

"What shall we say then?
Is the law sin?
God forbid.
Nay, I had not known sin,
but by the law:
for I had not known lust,
except the law had said,
Thou shalt not covet."

A spiritually dead man does not know he is spiritually dead. How can he know anything outside the only nature he has ever had? The law came and said, "Stop," and when he tried to stop and could not, he found out what nature he had.

That is what Scripture means when it says:

"What man knoweth the things of a man,
save the spirit of man which is in him?"

The spiritually dead man can only know the things of man. But when he receives the spirit that is of God in the new birth, he can know the things freely given to him by God.

Luke 16's Divorce Saying Points to the Change of Covenants

Luke 16:18 says:

"Whosoever putteth away his wife,
and marrieth another,
committeth adultery:
and whosoever marrieth her that is put away from her husband
committeth adultery."

There is no fornication clause in this verse. In other passages, Jesus gives that clause. Here He does not, because this verse is not primarily about marriage in the church today. It is talking about the change of covenants that freed Israel from the law and freed them to marry another, even Him who was raised from the dead.

Paul got his revelation from Jesus. When you assimilate the parables and teachings, you can find Romans 7 in the teachings of Jesus.

The Rich Man Context Shows Jesus Was Teaching Stewardship and Covenant

One law of meditation is never take a verse out of context. When studying parables and connected teachings, back up to where the subject begins and continue until it stops.

Luke 16 begins:

"There was a certain rich man..."

Later, verse 19 also says:

"There was a certain rich man..."

Jesus is teaching about stewardship, masters, and money. Verse 13 says:

"No servant can serve two masters...
Ye cannot serve God and mammon."

The Pharisees, who were covetous, heard these things and derided Him. In the middle of this, Jesus makes the statement about putting away a wife and marrying another.

He is not randomly interrupting a stewardship teaching with a disconnected marriage statement. He is speaking into the same covenant argument: Israel's marriage to God through the law and His impending death that would free them to be married to another.

Jesus' death would free Israel from the law without making the new marriage adultery.